

5.02 Discrete Random Variables			
5.02a	Probability distributions for general discrete random variables	a) Understand and be able to use discrete probability distributions. <i>Includes using and constructing probability distribution tables and functions relating to a given situation involving a discrete random variable.</i> <i>Any defined non-standard distribution will be finite.</i>	
5.02b		b) Understand and be able to calculate the expectation and variance of a discrete random variable. <i>Includes knowing and being able to use the formulae</i> $\mu = E(X) = \sum x_i p_i$ $\sigma^2 = \text{Var}(X) = \sum (x_i - \mu)^2 p_i = \sum x_i^2 p_i - \mu^2.$ <i>[Proof of these results is excluded.]</i>	
5.02c		c) Know and be able to use the effects of linear coding on the mean and variance of a random variable.	
5.02d	The binomial distribution	d) Know and be able to use the formulae $\mu = np$ and $\sigma^2 = np(1 - p)$ for a binomial distribution. <i>[Proof of these results is excluded.]</i> <i>For the underlying content on binomial distributions, see H240 sections 2.04b and 2.04c.</i>	
5.02e	The discrete uniform distribution	e) Know and be able to use the conditions under which a random variable will have a discrete uniform distribution, and be able to calculate probabilities and the mean and variance for a given discrete uniform distribution. <i>Includes use of the notation $X \sim U(n)$ for the uniform distribution over the interval $[1, n]$.</i>	

OCR Ref.	Subject Content	Stage 1 learners should...	Stage 2 learners should additionally...
5.02f	The geometric distribution	f) Know and be able to use the conditions under which a random variable will have a geometric distribution. <i>Includes use of the notation $X \sim \text{Geo}(p)$, where X is the number of trials up to and including the first success.</i>	
5.02g		g) Be able to calculate probabilities using the geometric distribution. <i>Learners may use the formulae $P(X = x) = (1 - p)^{x-1}p$ and $P(X > x) = (1 - p)^x$.</i>	
5.02h		h) Know and be able to use the formulae $\mu = \frac{1}{p}$ and $\sigma^2 = \frac{1-p}{p^2}$ for a geometric distribution. <i>[Proof of these results is excluded.]</i>	

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5.02i	The Poisson distribution	i) Understand informally the relevance of the Poisson distribution to the distribution of random events, and be able to use the Poisson distribution as a model. <i>Includes use of the notation $X \sim \text{Po}(\lambda)$, where X is the number of events in a given interval.</i>	
5.02j		j) Understand and be able to use the formula .	
5.02k		$P(X = x) = e^{-\lambda} \frac{\lambda^x}{x!}$ k) Be able to calculate probabilities using the Poisson distribution, using appropriate calculator functions. <i>Learners are expected to have a calculator with the ability to access probabilities from the Poisson distribution.</i> <i>[Use of the Poisson distribution to calculate numerical approximations for a binomial distribution is excluded.]</i>	
5.02l		l) Know and be able to use the conditions under which a random variable will have a Poisson distribution. <i>Learners will be expected to identify which of the modelling conditions [assumptions] is/are relevant to a given scenario and to explain them in context.</i>	
5.02m		m) Be able to use the result that if $X \sim \text{Po}(\lambda)$ then the mean and variance of X are each equal to λ.	
5.02n		n) Know and be able to use the result that the sum of independent Poisson variables has a Poisson distribution.	

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